



TWO FOR JOY

WHISPER IT gently, but Indian football is going through something of a renaissance led by its 100-match captain Baichung Bhutia (right) and striker Sunil Chetri, seen here celebrating victory in a Nehru Cup fixture.

B K RAMESH



BANGALORE | Temple Troubles

Ministers handling the 'temple portfolio' in the Karnataka Government could have been forgiven for believing that they would enjoy a relatively obstacle-free career path and a direct line to divine blessing. But a stream of those who have handled the hallowed portfolio—including two JD(S) and two Congress ministers—have tasted brutal defeat at the hustings. The latest is 60-year-old V. Somanna, the BJP's housing and temple minister. He lost the August 21 Assembly by-election to Congress greenhorn Priyakrishna, 25, the youngest MLA in Karnataka. Somanna had represented Govindarajanagar on a Congress ticket and was later poached by the BJP. His predecessor Krishnaiah Setty was asked to quit by Chief Minister B.S. Yeddyurappa even though he was close to the BJP leadership in the state and had even ordered special pujas for Yeddyurappa. Moral of the story: never take the gods for granted.

by Stephen David

THE GODS ARE SEEMINGLY TURNING A BLIND EYE TO TEMPLE MINISTERS WHO KEEP LOSING IN THE POLLS.

SOMANNA